



A gripping tail

Many South American monkeys have three “arms”—their tails are prehensile, so they can hold on to things. A spider monkey can hang by its strong tail, leaving both hands free for feeding.

All primates, including you, see in color.

Narrow chest

Monkeys’ legs are shorter than their arms.

This tamarin weighs only 21 ounces (600 grams), so it is light enough to scamper across small branches without breaking them.

People have chopped down so many of the trees that golden lion tamarins live in that there are only about 1,000 of these monkeys left in the wild.

Golden lion tamarins are 13–15 inches (32–37 centimeters) tall. They live in Brazil.

Hairy tail

Both eyes face forward to spot safe landing places!

Mane of soft, silky hair.

Monkeys are not fussy eaters. They eat fruit, flowers, lizards, butterflies, and even frogs’ legs!



Bath time

These Japanese snow monkeys relax and warm up in winter by sitting in pools of hot water that bubble up from beneath the icy ground.

